

Environmental Entomology (1995) 24, 298-305

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Mireille Fouillaud and Gilles Morel (1995)

Fungi associated with nests of the paper wasp *Polistes hebraeus* (Hymenoptera: Vespidae) on La Reunion Island

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Abstract: Paper wasp, *Polistes hebraeus* (F.), nests appear to serve as reservoirs of fungi. Eighty-nine fungal isolates were obtained from larvae and meconia of this wasp collected on La Réunion Island. Thirty-one fungal genera were recovered and at least 52 species identified. These numerous molds and yeasts survive or grow as saprophytes in excreta; among them two genera were predominant, *Aspergillus* and *Penicillium*. This mycoflora which is spread in the environment when the nest breaks up contains potentially entomopathogenic and phytopathogenic fungi, *Aspergillus flavus*, *Aspergillus tamarii*, *Paecilomyces farinosus*, *Alternaria alternata*, remaining viable after passing through wasp intestines.

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Research topic(s) for pests/diseases/weeds:

biocontrol - natural enemies

Research topic(s) for beneficials or antagonists:

environment/habitat manipulation

Pest and/or beneficial records:

Beneficial	Pest/Disease/Weed	Crop/Product	Country	Quarant.
Polistes olivaceus (predator)			Reunion Island	

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